Cambo Health Walks









CAMBO
gardens | arts | café | shop

Walking Scotland

Background Information

These walks have been developed by the Monday Walking Group which meets at the Cambo Visitor Centre each Monday morning at 9.30am, weather permitting.

The group walks are in association with Walking Scotland, a National Walking and Wheeling charity, whose purpose is to encourage walking by providing a framework for organised walking groups.

Walking Scotland use both terms walking and wheeling as it's more inclusive. Both words represent the action of moving at a pedestrian's pace, alone or using some kind of wheeled mobility aid.

The Walk Leaders have received appropriate training to ensure the walks are suitable and risk assessed for all attending, including those who use wheeled devices.

The walks are short, safe and social at a pace where we are able to talk They last approximately 1 → 1¼ hours and between 1 → 5km in length.

Depending on weather conditions, the paths may be slippery in places.

Cambo Gardens are managed by the Cambo Heritage Trust with its' simple aim for Cambo to be a place 'where people and plants grow'.



Background Information

The Cambo Estate has been in the Erskine family for 300 years and in 1976 Lady Catherine Erskine and her husband Sir Peter took over the estate and began offering volunteering and training opportunities to the local community and opened to the public in the 1980s at snowdrop time when the grounds around the house are carpeted white.

Developing the walled garden was a logical next step in making a garden of interest to visitors all through the year. The head gardener introduced bold planting inspired by the New Perennial Movement* using grasses and late season perennials that didn't need staking or deadheading, achieving high output for low input. In late summer and autumn these plantings reach a peak of beauty and interest as the grasses flower amongst herbaceous perennials including persicaria, asters, eupatorium and sedums.

The garden has entered a new chapter which may include training opportunities, an event space, and a contemporary cutting garden.
*Note: a naturalistic landscape and horticultural design style that mimics wild plant communities like prairies, meadows, and steppes.







Cambo Circular Walk



Walking Scotland

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Cambo Circular Walk

General Description:

This walk takes you from the Stables Visitor Centre heading south past the 'Fairy Door' and down a sloping, woodland path towards the entrance to the Cambo Burn.

On the way, look out for the 'badger run', used at night-time, that crosses the main path. On reaching the burn, cross the first bridge* and turn left to head back in the direction of the Stables. Take note of the interesting rock formations and tree root systems on this section of the Cambo Den.

As you walk along, now with the burn on your left, keep a lookout for the badger sett on the opposite bank of the burn.

Just before the next bridge, we take a sharp right up a fairly steep incline and through a gate, that brings us to the edge of the woodland.

Follow the path along the side of the field, past the compost bins and, keeping the woodlands on our left, continue along the path, past the 'Off-Grid' holiday accommodation, until we reach a bank of solar panels stretching across the field.

Turn right at this point and, with the solar panels on your left, go along until you reach a track, used by farm vehicles, whereupon you turn left and follow the track up a gradual incline to the Kingsbarns Distillery.

Walk past the front of the Distillery and along the entrance road keeping an eye on the edge of the woodland for an opening, beside which there is the following sign…



Go through this opening, taking care as the path has a downward slope and a sharp bend to the left. Further down the path you cross a bridge* and turn right along a path keeping the burn on your right.

Keep an eye out for the sleeping bear!

Cambo Circular Walk

You will join the original path, go past the 'badger run' and 'Fairy Door' then through an opening taking you to the Stables Visitor Centre.

*Note: some of the bridges only have handrails on the one side!

Pathway Conditions:

The gravel paths are clear and wide enough for a wheeled walking aid. There are some inclines, both down and up, where extra care is necessary, particularly on the downward inclines. When crossing the field with the solar panels, care should be taken as, depending on recent weather, the soil conditions may not be suitable for wheeled walking.

Weather Considerations:

In Autumn, the paths have a good covering of leaves that can be slippery when wet.

In winter, the path may be slippery in places during frosty weather but should remain mostly passable.

Interesting Features:

Fairy door, tree root systems, rock formations, badger sett, compost bins, Distillery, Cambo Den.

Walk Leader Agreement

*We will always try to make the walk safe for you by doing a risk assessment

*We will describe the route and any hazards to you before we start walking and will let you decide how far you want to walk

*We will try to make sure that all staff and volunteers have done the Walking Scotland Walk Leader training course

*We will try to find a walk that is suitable for everyone

Walking Scotland

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Walker Agreement

* I will only do the walk if I am fit enough. If I have any concerns about this I will talk to a Walk Leader or a health professional

* I will tell a Walk Leader if I feel unwell while out on a walk

* I will let a Walk Leader know if I am leaving the walk before it has ended

* It is up to me to make sure I can do the Health Walk safely

* I understand that I come on a Health Walk at my own risk

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Strength & Balance

1 THE BACK KNEE STRENGTHENER:

Do this one standing in front of a bench or table.

Stand up tall and bend one knee, bringing your foot **slowly** towards your bottom Hold for a low count of 3. Keep the knee of the bent leg slightly behind the knee of the straight leg

Return to the starting position slowly.

Again, try this 5 times on each side at first and build up to 10 times with each leg.



2 KNEE BENDS:

Stand facing the bench or table as before.

Place your feet shoulder width apart. Bend your knees and squat down by about 10cm (4") by bending your knees. Come up and repeat. Keep your back straight and don't let your knees extend over your toes.

This exercise will strengthen the big muscles in your hips and thighs, and will improve your balance. This can help when climbing stairs, walking, or bending to speak to someone.

Try this exercise 5 times and build up to 10 repetitions as you get stronger. You could also hold the squat for a few seconds.



3 CALF RAISES WITH SUPPORT:

Stand facing the bench or table as before.

Hold on and look straight ahead.

Position your feet hip width apart. Slowly and with control come up onto your toes, hold for a slow count of 3 and lower your heels back down.

Repeat this exercise 5 times, building up to 10 or more. As your balance improves, try holding on with just one hand or fingertips.

This exercise strengthens your calf muscles and toe joints. It helps you manage everyday activities such as hanging out washing, or reaching up into high cupboards.



4 TOE RAISES WITH SUPPORT:

Stand tall beside a bench or table.

Hold on and look ahead. Your feet should be hip width apart. Come back onto your heels, raising the front of your feet off the floor, then lower your toes back to the ground. Don't let your body hinge at the hips, keep the body as straight as possible.

Repeat this exercise 5 times and build up to 10 or more. As your balance improves, try holding on with just one hand or fingertips.

This strengthens your lower leg muscles and will make it easier for you to step backwards, or do fun things like push your grandchildren on the swings!



5 SIDE HIP STRENGTHENER:

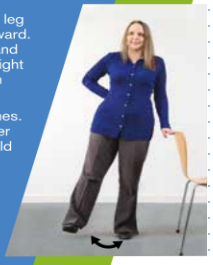
Stand tall beside a bench or table.

Hold on and keep your exercising leg straight, with the foot straight forward. Slowly lift the leg out to the side and return. Try and keep the body upright and only move the leg, rather than swinging over to the side.

Repeat 5 times, build up to 10 times. Swap round and exercise the other leg. Lift the leg out to the side, hold for a slow count of 3 and return.

Try to keep the body upright and only move the leg, rather than the top part of your body.

This strengthens your hip muscles and helps you with stepping up over pavements or kerbs.



6 SIDEWAYS WALKING:

Stand up tall and place your hands on your hips.

Use a support in front of you if needed such as a wall or railing. Take 10 steps to the right, pause and then take 10 steps to the left.

This exercise is good for moving in a sideways direction, for example stepping out of the way on a pavement to allow someone past.

TAKE CARE



Walking Scotland